

Clarification request — how school accounts are coded to function

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To: Superintendent of Schools, Lunenburg Public Schools **Subject:** Which function coding is authoritative for the school budget **Generated:** 2026-09-03 by `scripts/build_coding_questions.py`

This is a request for clarification, not a finding. Two documents we hold code the same school accounts to different function codes. **Nothing here establishes that either coding is wrong** — we do not hold the chart of accounts that would settle it, which is why we are asking rather than concluding.

The reason it matters: this project groups school spending by function to describe where the budget goes. If we group by the wrong one, our published figures mis-describe the district. We would rather ask than guess.

The two documents

The Town's ledger	<code>FY26 BUDGET YEAR TO DATE REPORT (9-1-2026).xlsx</code> — the MUNIS glytdbud year-to-date budget report for FY2026 period 12, provided by the Town Accountant. Its <code>ACCOUNT</code> column carries the full account string, e.g. <code>0100-3-300-2330-03-2-12-1-511103</code> .
The district's workbook	<code>sources/xlsx/fy27-proposals.xlsx</code> , the FY27 budget projection, which prints a function code at the head of each group, e.g. <code>2330 - Paraprofessionals Special Education</code> .

Read against each other for the school department in FY2026, **38 of 45 function codes carry the same total in both**. 7 do not, by \$1,010,646 in total.

Suggested wording

*I maintain a public, non-commercial site explaining the Lunenburg town and school budgets to residents, built from published documents and records the Town has provided. I compared two documents for FY2026, school department: the Town Accountant's MUNIS year-to-date budget report and the district's FY27 budget projection workbook. Both state a budgeted amount against the same function codes. **38 of 45 function codes agree. 7 do not.** In those 7 cases the two documents state different amounts under the same code for the same year, so they cannot both be right. Below is each one, stated plainly. I have not tried to work out which document is correct, because nothing I hold can decide it. In a further **2** codes the totals agree while the individual lines inside do not. Those are listed after the others. (The workbook states whole dollars and the ledger states cents, so I have treated a difference of under a dollar per*

account as rounding and left it out. Nothing larger than that is excluded.) **The whole of it in one table.** Every item below is set out in full further down; this is so you can see the shape of it first. The right-hand column is my reading, not a finding. **The amounts are the sums involved, not money missing, and they do not add up to anything.** In most rows both documents hold the same total and disagree only about where it sits. Only row 4 is an amount one document has and the other does not. | | what the two documents do differently | codes: ledger vs book | sum involved | my guess | |---|---|---|---:|---| | **1** |

Social worker salaries — Under **Guidance** in the Town's books; under their own heading **Social Worker Salaries** in the budget book | 2710 vs 2900 | \$369,029 | Same money, filed in two places. Nothing missing | | **2** | **ELL staff and the ACE resource room teacher** — Each is under a different one of two codes in each document | 2310 ↔ 2320 (swapped) | \$90,219 | One document has these two the wrong way round | | **3** | **Salary reserve** — Coded 0300 in the Town's books; carried with no function code at all in the budget book | 0300 vs — | \$90,770 | Same line. Nothing missing | | **4** | **Curriculum Adoption** — In the budget book. **No matching account in the Town's ledger** | — vs 2110 | \$40,000 | **No guess.** This is the one I cannot place | | **5** | **P.S. Repair Office Machines** — Under a different code in each document | 4230 vs 4220 | \$690 | The same line, coded two ways | | **6** | **Athletic insurance and dues** — One account of \$29,000 in the Town's books; two lines in the budget book | 3510 | \$29,000 | The budget book shows it after a transfer, the ledger before | | **7** | **Special education instructional materials** — All on the Middle School in the Town's books; split between two schools in the budget book | 2415 | \$1,896 | A keying difference. The totals are identical | | **8** | **The two kindergarten accounts** — Spent against, with **no appropriation and no transfer** in the Town's books | 2330 | \$99,064 | **No guess.** This is a plain question | **One document would answer most of it:** the account master — the mapping from each MUNIS account number to its function code. If that can be exported, rows 1, 2, 3, 5 and 7 answer themselves. Rows 4, 6 and 8 would still need a word from you: an account master cannot show a line that has no account, explain a transfer, or say where a position was budgeted. **1. Function 0300 — no group under this code in the workbook** - Town ledger: \$90,770, across 1 account. - District workbook: \$0. - **\$90,770 is stated under this code in one document and not the other.** - The workbook does carry a line of that amount — Salary Reserve — but under a section heading (TOTAL SALARIES) rather than a function code, so it appears under no code at all. Ledger accounts: 0100-3-300-0300-99-0-99-4-517006 SCHSALRESE \$90,770 **2. Function 2310 — Tutoring Cont. Ser. / Teachers Specialists - Special Education** - Town ledger: \$2,187,067, across 8 accounts. - District workbook: \$2,096,848. - **\$90,219 is stated under this code in one document and not the other.** Ledger accounts: 0100-3-300-2310-51-2-06-1-511001 PS SPED TE \$635,488; 0100-3-300-2310-51-5-06-1-511001 MS SPED RE \$453,676; 0100-3-300-2310-51-6-06-1-511001 HS SPED RE \$449,087; 0100-3-300-2310-51-4-06-1-511001 ES SPED RE \$344,938 Workbook lines: P.S. Special Ed Teachers \$635,488; M.S. Specl Ed Resourse Rm Teacher \$453,676; H.S. Specl Ed Resourse Rm Teacher \$449,087; ES Special Ed Teachers \$344,938 **3. Function 2320 — Therapeutic Services** - Town ledger: \$663,335, across 7 accounts. - District workbook: \$753,555. - **\$90,220 is stated under this code in one document and not the other.** Ledger accounts: 0100-3-300-2320-51-1-06-1-511001 SPEC SAL \$195,946; 0100-3-300-2320-51-2-06-1-511001 PS PATH SA \$148,028; 0100-3-300-2320-51-1-06-1-511025 ACERESROOM \$95,659; 0100-3-300-2320-51-4-06-1-511001 ES SPEECH \$81,483 Workbook lines: Special Ed Specialists/System \$195,946; District Wide Specials (ELL) \$185,878; P.S. Special Ed Speech Pathologists \$148,028; E.S. Special Ed Speech Pathologists \$81,483 **4.**

Function 2710 — Guidance Exp. / Guidance Salaries - Town ledger: **\$753,939**, across 13 accounts. - District workbook: **\$384,910**. - **\$369,028 is stated under this code in one document and not the other.** Ledger accounts: 0100-3-300-2710-06-6-65-1-511001 HS GUIDANC \$209,884; 0100-3-300-2710-05-5-65-1-511001 MS GUIDANC \$147,680; 0100-3-300-2710-04-4-65-1-511024 SOCWORKSAL \$92,939; 0100-3-300-2710-05-5-65-1-511024 SOCWORKSAL \$92,939 Workbook lines: H.S. Guidance Counselor \$209,884; M.S. Guidance Counselor \$147,680; H.S. Lease of Guidance Software \$13,800; H.S. Guidance Supplies \$6,954

5. Function 2900 — Social Worker Salaries - Town ledger: **\$0**, across 0 accounts. - District workbook: **\$369,029**. - **\$369,029 is stated under this code in one document and not the other.** Workbook lines: P.S. Social Worker \$92,939; E.S. Social Worker \$92,939; M.S. Social Worker \$92,939; H.S. Social Worker \$90,212

6. Function 4220 — Maint. of Buildings - Town ledger: **\$367,000**, across 3 accounts. - District workbook: **\$367,690**. - **\$690 is stated under this code in one document and not the other.** Ledger accounts: 0100-3-300-4220-01-1-74-2-535006 CONT SERV \$257,000; 0100-3-300-4220-99-1-74-2-541002 BLDG MTC \$80,000; 0100-3-300-4220-99-1-74-2-545004 EMERG EXP \$30,000 Workbook lines: Maint. of Buildings/Contracted Services \$257,000; Maint. of Bldg Supplies/System \$80,000; Emergency Expenditures \$30,000; P.S. Repair Office Machines \$690

7. Function 4230 — M.S. Repairs / H.S. Repairs / Maintenance Repairs - Town ledger: **\$57,145**, across 8 accounts. - District workbook: **\$56,455**. - **\$690 is stated under this code in one document and not the other.** Ledger accounts: 0100-3-300-4230-99-1-74-2-525009 FIRE/FURNI \$24,005; 0100-3-300-4230-99-1-76-2-524100 VEH MTC \$19,000; 0100-3-300-4230-99-1-74-2-525011 REP EQ MTC \$5,000; 0100-3-300-4230-99-1-52-2-525008 COMP MTC \$4,500 Workbook lines: Fire Safety/Furniture Repair \$24,005; Vehicle Maintenance/Repairs \$19,000; Repair of Equip/Maintenance \$5,000; Computer MTC / Repair System \$4,500

8. Function 2415 — P.S. Other Instr. Materials / E.S. Other Instr. Materials / M.S. Other Instr. Materials / H.S. Other Instr. Materials. The totals agree; the lines inside do not. - Both documents state **\$83,931** under this code. - The ledger has 0100-3-300-2415-51-5-05-2-555055 (SPEDINSTRM) at **\$1,896**. The workbook has no line of that amount under this code. - The workbook has E.S. Special Education Instr. Materials at **\$1,492**. The ledger has no account of that amount under this code. - The workbook has M.S. Special Education Instr. Materials at **\$404**. The ledger has no account of that amount under this code. Which line is each of these dollars actually budgeted against?

9. Function 3510 — Athletic Expenses / Athletics Salaries. The totals agree; the lines inside do not. - Both documents state **\$518,334** under this code. - The ledger has 0100-3-300-3510-06-6-67-2-535018 (ATH INS) at **\$29,000**. The workbook has no line of that amount under this code. - The workbook has Athletic Insurance at **\$9,000**. The ledger has no account of that amount under this code. - The workbook has Athletic Dues & Fees at **\$20,000**. The ledger has no account of that amount under this code. Which line is each of these dollars actually budgeted against?

10. The two kindergarten accounts. In FY2026 the ledger shows: - 0100-3-300-2330-03-2-12-1-511103 (KINDAIDREG) — appropriation \$0, transfers \$0, spent **\$93,691** - 0100-3-300-2330-03-2-13-1-511203 (KINDPARREG) — appropriation \$0, transfers \$0, spent **\$5,373**

\$99,064 was spent against accounts with no appropriation and no transfer. The workbook records prior-year spending on Kindergarten Paraprofessionals of \$75,502, \$77,700, \$83,766 and nothing at all on Kindergarten Aides/Regular, so the object code these charges land on changed in FY2026. Where were these positions provided for in the FY2026 approved budget? If I have misread any of the above, telling me so is a complete answer and I would be glad to have it. Nothing will

be published on this until you reply. --- ### What I think may be going on — guesses, not conclusions
 These are my best reading of the pattern, offered so you can confirm or correct them quickly rather than
 work back from the arithmetic above. **None of it is established and none of it will be published.** If
 a guess is simply wrong, saying so is the most useful reply. **1. Social workers.** The Town's books carry
 4 social-worker salary accounts — \$369,029 in total — inside **Guidance**. The budget book carries the
 same total under its own heading, **Social Worker Salaries**. My guess is that this is the same money
 filed in two places and that nothing is missing. If so, the word "Guidance" means something different in
 each document. Which grouping does the district use when it reports to DESE? **2. Two staff lines that
 look swapped.** The budget book puts **District Wide Specials (ELL)** (\$185,878) under Therapeutic
 Services, while the Town's books put it under Specialist Teachers. **ACE Special Ed Resource Rm
 Teacher** (\$95,659) goes the other way. My guess is that one of the two documents has these two the
 wrong way round — the difference between them is exactly the \$90,219 the two codes are out by. Which is
 right? **3. The salary reserve.** Both documents show \$90,770, so nothing is missing. The budget book
 simply lists it without a function code, and the Town's books give it code 0300. My guess is these are the
 same line. Should the budget book carry a code for it? **4. Curriculum Adoption — the one I cannot
 place at all.** The budget book has **\$40,000** for it. I can find no account in the Town's ledger that
 corresponds, and the professional development account of the same size is already matched to a different
 budget line. Taking every line on both sides, the budget book totals **\$2** more than the Town's ledger for
 the school department, and this single line accounts for all but -\$39,998 of that. Was it budgeted, and
 against which account? **5. Athletic insurance.** The Town's books show this account appropriated at
\$29,000, with **\$20,000** moved out of it during the year, leaving **\$9,000**. The budget book shows
\$9,000 for insurance and a separate **\$20,000** line for dues and fees. My guess is that the budget book is
 showing the position after that transfer while the ledger column I am reading shows it before. If that is
 right, then the budget book's FY26 column is not the original appropriation everywhere, and I need to
 know which lines it applies to. **6. Special education instructional materials.** The Town's books put
 the whole **\$1,896** on the Middle School and nothing on the Elementary School. The budget book splits it,
 \$1,492 to Elementary and \$404 to Middle. My guess is a keying difference rather than anything
 substantive, since the total is identical. Which school is the money actually against? **7. Kindergarten.** I
 have no guess for this one, which is why it is a plain question above.

What each question settles, and what it does not

QUESTION	SETTLES	DOES NOT SETTLE
The account master	All 7 cases at once, and permanently	Whether any figure already published used the wrong grouping
The 7 function codes individually (0300, 2310, 2320, 2710, 2900, 4220, 4230)	Which grouping this project should publish for each	Why the two documents differ. Nothing in the archive tests that, and this request does not ask
The kindergarten accounts	Where the positions were provided for	Whether anyone was employed, or how many. A budget line is dollars, never people

What is NOT being asked

- **No document is being requested that the Town has already sent.** The back-year

MUNIS reports are in `notes/DATA-REQUEST.md` and are the Town Accountant's to provide, not the Superintendent's.

- **No explanation of a variance.** The FY26 year-end figures are still being

reconciled; the Town Manager said so when the report was sent, and this asks nothing that depends on them being final.

- **Nothing is characterised as an error.** In every case below, the district and

the Town each hold one of two codings and the archive cannot rank them.

For the record

The district publishes a great deal — the FY27 workbook carries five years of actuals line by line, which most districts do not — and the Town produced the period 12 ledger on request within a day. This request exists because those two documents are detailed enough to be compared at all.